

Rolando Daniel Vela

Software Engineer | AI and Machine Learning

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University

Master of Science in Computer Science | GPA: 3.03/4.00

Evanston, IL

Anticipated June 2029

Northwestern University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering & AI | GPA: 3.03/4.00

Evanston, IL

Anticipated June 2029

SKILLS

Technical: AutoCAD, Autodesk Inventor, Onshape, 3D Printing, Machining (CNC, Mill, Lathe), Prototyping

Software: MATLAB, Python, Java, JavaScript, Vscode, Office 365, Adobe Suite

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder of InternetWear

Online Company Management

Laredo, TX

June 2022 – Present

- Founded and scaled a multi-channel e-commerce enterprise to \$65k in revenue with 50%+ profit margins, conducting data-driven market analysis to identify niche trends
- Designed proprietary products using Adobe Creative Suite and drove customer acquisition through social media marketing, achieving an 8% ad click-through rate
- Engineered a lean, automated supply chain architecture to manage end-to-end fulfillment across eBay, Walmart, and Etsy, optimizing the pipeline from digital order to final delivery
- Managed monthly P&L reporting, tax compliance, and margin analysis, leveraging data analytics to sustain profitability through the business's scale-up

Powell Watson Motors Inc.

Intern – Backend Network Development and AI Integration

Laredo, TX

June 2026 – September 2026

- Maintained enterprise LAN infrastructure and network endpoints to ensure localized connectivity
- Deployed an AI chatbot streamlining the vehicle-selection pipeline, boosting customer completion rates by 30%
- Designed and deployed NFC-enabled WiFi and review-prompt signage across 3 locations, driving ~100 daily scans and a 4.5-star Google location rating

Limitless Learning Education and Tutoring Center — AP Tutor

June 2024 – September 2024

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

AI-Driven Gamified Learning Platform

Full-Stack & AI Developer

Evanston, IL

June 2026

- Programmed FIFADEx, a multistage AI pipeline on FastAPI that uses Docling AI for video transcription and IBM Granite (via Watsonx.ai) to cross-reference commentary, mapping data into a gamified learning dashboard
- Presented FIFADEx at the IBM SkillsBuild AI Builders Challenge as part of a 5-person team

Northwestern Rocketry Club

Fin Team Designer | Manufacturer

Evanston, IL

September 2025 – Present

- Designed tapered swept fin geometries in Onshape to optimize aerodynamic stability and minimize wave drag for a competition rocket targeting a 12,000-foot apogee and transonic flight profiles
- Manufactured precision aluminum and carbon-fiber components via Onshape CAM/CNC to meet load specs

Assistive Flexure Device

Northwestern University — Engineering Design Project

Evanston, IL

September 2024 – December 2024

- Led a 4-person team to design a parametric CAD model in Onshape, utilizing compliant mechanisms and 3D printing to achieve mechanical flexures for a care facility

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

Lambda Upsilon Lambda Fraternity, Inc. — *Council Relations Chair*

December 2025 – Present

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers — *Treasurer*

September 2025 – Present

ASME Robotics — *Mechanical Design Lead*

Fall 2025 – Present

Awards: Jane Street Focus Participant, Greenwood Fintech Academy Fellow, and HSF Scholar